LIKES

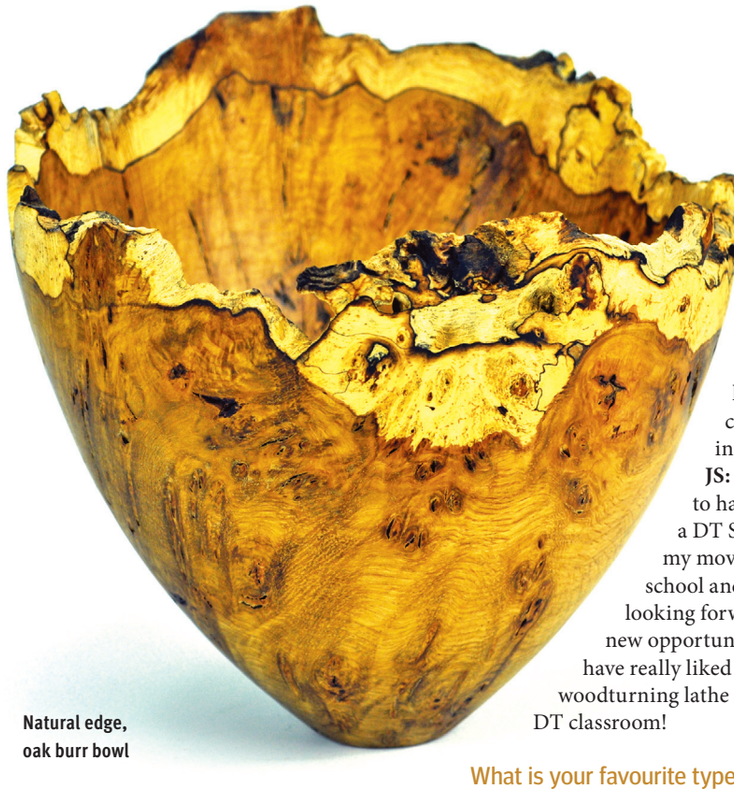
- Cutting the log and turning it into something wonderful
- The relatively short time it takes to do the above
- The limits to what we create are only set by us
- After I have cleaned the workshop and sit there having a coffee
- Having my children around making and being creative in the workshop

DISLIKES

- Dust
- Finishing a project only to find a fault in my finishing and having to start again

HANDY HINTS

- Learn how to use your tools with confidence; a good tutor will save you years of wasted time
- Check the quality of your sanding, adding a finish rarely makes it better!
- Watch everybody – there's always something to learn
- Inspiration comes from everywhere, we just need to see it
- If your shape is good, it normally looks good
- Enjoy the adventure



Natural edge, oak burr bowl

Hornbeam bowl coloured using spirit stains

There is always the reality of what sells however, so last Saturday I spent the morning rough-turning a dozen ash (*Fraxinus excelsior*) salad bowls!

JS: I have just made a pen for my friend's birthday. I have also just finished a bowl with a multi-coloured rim and pyrography work.

What is the one piece of equipment or tool you would not be without and why?

SS: The obvious answer would be the lathe, because that's where it all starts and without it we would all be woodworkers and not turners! I am lucky to have so much equipment, from tiny dentist drills to large chainsaws, airbrushes to blowtorches and I love using them all!

JS: I love the little pen turning lathe, because pens were one of the first things that I made and also it was the first lathe that I used as dad could get it at the right level. I also love all of the little high-speed drill pieces and pyrography burning bits.

If you could change one thing what would it be and why?

SS: In woodturning terms, I would want to change the public's perception of the value of wood and the items made from it. Only then will the true value of our work be understood by the general public and a sensible living made by turners. This would also help encourage young artists like Jessica to consider a career in wood art.

JS: I am very lucky to have been awarded a DT Scholarship for my move into the senior school and am really looking forward to all the new opportunities, but I would have really liked to have seen a woodturning lathe in the DT classroom!

What is your favourite type of turning?

SS: It would have to be bowls and platters as they allow so many opportunities to enhance and add artistic features in a short time, allowing it to be sold at a saleable price!

I always like to have a project on the go that takes hours to complete and I can just work on here and there, but normally these end up in my collection as the cost makes them unsaleable!

JS: I love turning pens, which is lucky as my friends always like them for birthday presents! I also have great fun colouring and texturing my bowls and I really like sanding.

If you had one wish, what would you wish for?

SS: I wish that I live long enough to continue this fantastic journey and hopefully get somewhere near the end!

JS: That my life will be filled up with a creative path.

If you could have one piece of equipment, what would it be and why.

SS: I have got the most fantastic workshop overlooking the lake. It has large sliding doors that open fully allowing a large through-flow of fresh air, which is ideal when sanding but it would be great to install a powerful extraction system to all lathe points and workbenches. I think we all dislike the dust we create and would love to get rid of it!!

JS: Dad's workshop seems to have everything in it, so a woodturning lathe at school would be great. ●

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